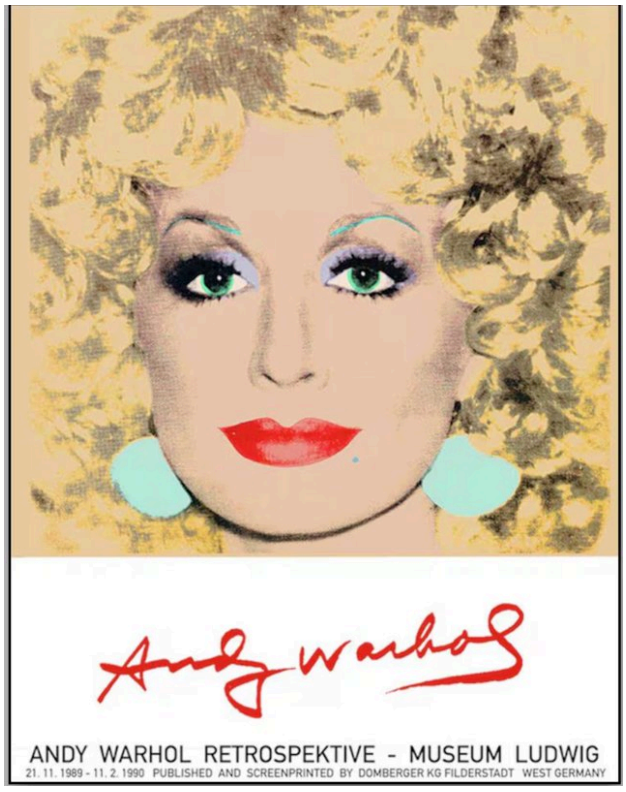
Dolly Parton: An American Legacy

Student pack · Première bac pro · B1



Andy Warhol, Dolly Parton, 1985. Poster of the Andy Warhol retrospective, Museum Ludwig, Cologne, 1989-1990. © The Andy Warhol Foundation for the Visual Arts. This work is protected by copyright. It is reproduced here as a one-off exception for teaching purposes, from Madame Carole Paoli Pompougnac's own copy of the poster.

Designed by Madame Carole Paoli Pompougnac

BO spécial n° 5 du 11 avril 2019 · Nine lessons of 55 minutes

https://itineraires-destinations.fr/dolly-parton-american-legacy/

© 2026 Madame Carole Paoli Pompougnac · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Why this sequence?

Dolly Rebecca Parton (19 January 1946 to 25 August 2026) was born in a one-room cabin in Locust Ridge, in the Great Smoky Mountains of East Tennessee. She became a singer, a songwriter, an actress, a businesswoman and one of the most generous donors in American culture. She was also the honorary godmother of Miley Cyrus. She died in Nashville on 25 August 2026, aged 80. In this sequence we talk about her life in the past.

When a famous person dies, two stories begin at the same time. The first is the story of what she really left: songs, jobs, books, values. The second is the story people invent: rumours, fake videos, "secret" inheritances. This sequence studies both, and asks you to tell the difference.

> ***The big question of the sequence.*** *Is a legacy what a person leaves behind, or what other people decide to make of it?*

This is an open question. At the end of the sequence, you will defend your own answer.

The nine lessons

Lesson	Debatable question	Grammar for the task
1. An icon in colour	Does a portrait show a person, or the image the public wants?	present simple / present continuous; look, look like; comparatives and superlatives
2. Rags to rhinestones	Can you be proud of where you come from and still reinvent yourself completely?	past simple; used to; order of adjectives
3. Backstage	Who really makes a star: the star or the team?	polite requests, offers, suggestions; I'd rather
4. 9 to 5	Can a pop song change the way people see work?	frequency adverbs; have to, must, mustn't, don't have to, should
5. Dollywood	Is a theme park a gift to a region or simply a business?	past simple vs present perfect; since / for; big numbers
6. Aunt Dolly	What can you really pass on to someone who is not your child?	reported speech: say, tell, ask
7. True or Tale?	Why do we want to believe a rumour, even when there is no evidence?	modals of deduction; According to... / There is no evidence that...
8. Dolly's legacy	Is generosity a private choice or a public duty for the very rich?	purpose: to, in order to, so that; present passive; will
9. Final task	Can you present a legacy, play a professional scene and expose a rumour?	review

Final task. Backstage at the tribute concert. In groups, you prepare a tribute concert for Dolly Parton. You present her life, you play a backstage scene with a professional (dresser, hairdresser or make-up artist) and you tell the audience the truth about the inheritance rumour.

Every fact in this sequence has been checked. One famous claim, "Dolly left everything to Miley", is not verified: we study it as a rumour in Lesson 7, never as a fact.

Lesson 1. An icon in colour: Warhol's Dolly

Debatable question: Does a portrait show a person, or the image the public wants?
By the end of this lesson, I can: describe a portrait, say what a person looks like and give my impression, compare two images.


Andy Warhol, Dolly Parton, 1985
Andy Warhol, *Dolly Parton*, 1985. Poster of the Andy Warhol retrospective, Museum Ludwig, Cologne, 1989-1990. © The Andy Warhol Foundation for the Visual Arts. Protected work, reproduced as a one-off teaching exception.

Stop point (minute 46). If you reach minute 46, the essential is done: every student has described the poster aloud. The written record can be copied from the board.

Emergency exit (8 minutes, if you are late or the projector fails). Skip exercises 4 and 5. Each student says three sentences about the poster (one present simple, one present continuous, one with looks like) to their neighbour, then the class votes for the most precise description. Written record dictated in two minutes.

Step 1-2. Diagnostic assessment (see the student sheet at the end of this lesson)

Step 3. The question of the day

Show the poster without saying who it is. Ask:

1. Who do you think this is? A singer, an actress, a doll?
2. Is this a photo or a painting? How do you know?
3. Would you like a portrait of yourself like this? Why or why not?

Then give the information: it is Dolly Parton, an American country singer, painted by Andy Warhol in 1985. Warhol (1928-1987) made famous portraits of stars such as Marilyn Monroe. He used silkscreen printing so that the same face could be repeated like a product.

Transition. To answer the question of the day (person or public image?), we first need precise words to describe what we see.

Step 4. Expanding your vocabulary

A. Words for the portrait (theme vocabulary)

Word	Meaning	Example in context
a portrait	a picture of a person	This is a portrait of Dolly Parton.
pop art	an art movement (1950s-1970s and after) using bright colours and images from popular culture	Andy Warhol was a pop art painter.
a silkscreen	a printing method that pushes ink through a fine screen	Warhol used silkscreens to repeat images.
platinum blonde	a very light, silvery blonde	Her curls are platinum blonde.
curls	round locks of hair	She has big curls.
turquoise	blue-green	She wears big turquoise earrings.
lilac	light purple	Her eyeshadow is lilac.
scarlet	bright red	Her lips are scarlet.
pale peach	a very light orange-pink	The background is pale peach.
the background / the foreground	the part behind / in front	Her face is in the foreground.
an icon	a famous person who represents an idea or a time	Dolly became an American icon.
striking	very easy to notice, impressive	The red lips are the most striking detail.

B. Words to analyse and give an opinion

Function	Words
Describe the place in the picture	in the foreground, in the background, in the middle, on the left / right, at the top / bottom
Give an impression	She looks + adjective · She looks like + noun · She seems + adjective · It gives the impression that...
Give an opinion	I think that... · In my opinion,... · To me,... · I find it + adjective
Nuance	rather, quite, a bit, almost, not really
Contrast	but, whereas, while, however

Exercises on vocabulary

Exercise A1. Match the detail and the colour.

1. her hair · 2. her eyes · 3. her eyeshadow · 4. her lips · 5. her earrings · 6. the background

a. lilac · b. scarlet · c. turquoise · d. platinum blonde · e. pale peach · f. green

Exercise A2. Fill in the gaps with: icon · striking · background · foreground · pop art

Warhol was a (1) __ **painter. In this portrait, Dolly's face is in the (2) _** ***and the (3) is pale peach. The most (4) detail is her red mouth. With this portrait, she became an (5)*** ___.

Exercise A3. Reformulate with a nuance word (rather, quite, a bit, almost).
1. The colours are very bright. → (a bit too)
2. Her hair fills the picture. → (almost)
3. She looks artificial. → (rather)

Flashcards of the lesson

Make at least six cards: four blue (theme), one green (opinion), one red (grammar).

Front	Back
striking (blue)	very easy to notice · *The red lips are the most striking detail.* · STRI-king
She looks like + noun (red)	elle ressemble à · *She looks like a film star.* · no "like" before an adjective
whereas (green)	alors que · *The photo is realistic, whereas the portrait is artificial.* · where-AS

Step 5. The teacher's point

Teacher script. Show the poster. Ask: What do you see? Write two columns on the board: "always true in the picture" / "happening now in the picture". Students give examples, then add look and look like. Finish with a comparison between the poster and an official photo of Dolly (teacher's choice, from an official website).

Point	Form	Examples
Present simple: facts, features	subject + verb (+ s with he/she/it)	She has green eyes. She wears big earrings.
Present continuous: what is happening in the picture	be + verb-ing	She is smiling. She is looking at us.
State verbs	have (a feature), be, like, know: not in the continuous	✗ She is having green eyes. ✓ She has green eyes.
look + adjective	She looks happy.	
look like + noun	She looks like a film star.	
Comparatives	short: bright → brighter than; long: colourful → more colourful than; irregular: good → better, bad → worse	Her hair is brighter than in real life.
Superlatives	the brightest, the most striking	The lips are the most striking detail.

Quick check. Correct: *She is having green eyes.*

Step 6. Exercises

Exercise 1. look or look like?
1. She ... happy. 2. She ... a film star. 3. The colours ... very bright. 4. The earrings ... two big sweets. 5. The portrait ... a poster from the 1980s.

Exercise 2. Present simple or present continuous?
1. Dolly (smile) ... in the portrait. 2. She (have) ... big curly hair. 3. She (look) ... straight at us. 4. Warhol (use) ... bright colours in his portraits. 5. The background (be) ... pale peach.

Exercise 3. Compare the poster and an official photo.
1. In the portrait, her hair is (bright) ... than in the photo. 2. The colours are (artificial) ... 3. The photo is (realistic) ... 4. The red lips are the (striking) ... detail.

Exercise 4. Transform into the present continuous when possible. If it is impossible, explain why.
1. She smiles. 2. She has turquoise earrings. 3. She looks at the camera. 4. She knows the painter.

Exercise 5. Short production. Write six sentences: two in the present simple, two in the present continuous, one with looks or looks like, one comparative.

Model answer: Dolly has big platinum curls. She wears turquoise earrings. She is smiling. She is looking straight at us. She looks like a film star. The colours are brighter than in real life.

Help box. Use this frame: *In the foreground, I can see... She has... She is... She looks like... The colours are ...-er than...*

Going further. Use *seem to be + -ing*: *She seems to be enjoying the moment.* Use *far / much + comparative*: *The portrait is far more colourful than a photo.*

Step 7. Speaking task: "The guided tour"

Groups of four. Each student is a museum guide for 45 seconds and presents the poster to the group.

1. Student A: what you see (foreground, background, colours).
2. Student B: what she is doing and what she looks like.
3. Student C: comparison with a photo.
4. Student D: answer the question of the day: *Does the portrait show the person or the public image?* Start with *In my opinion,...* and use *whereas*.

Then the groups swap roles once if time allows. The listeners tick on a card each word of the lesson they hear.

Possible answer for student D: In my opinion, the portrait shows the public image, whereas a photo shows the person. The colours are far brighter than in real life, so she looks like a doll or a product. Warhol shows a star, not the private woman.

Step 8. Written record

> ***Lesson 1. An icon in colour***
> *Warhol's Dolly Parton (1985) is a pop art portrait. In the foreground, Dolly has big platinum curls, green eyes, lilac eyeshadow and scarlet lips. She is smiling and looking at us. She looks like a film star.*
> ***Grammar.*** *Present simple = what is always true (she has); present continuous = what is happening in the picture (she is smiling). look + adjective / look like + noun. Comparatives: brighter than, more colourful than.*
> ***My answer to the question:*** *The portrait shows ... rather than ..., because ...*

Step 9. Homework

1. Make six flashcards (four blue, one green, one red). Revise them with the 3-box method.
2. Describe a famous person in five sentences without saying the name (one with looks like, one comparative). Next lesson, the class will guess.
3. Help box: record yourself (one minute) reading your five sentences.

Diagnostic assessment (Lesson 1)

Student sheet

Name: __ Class: _ *Date:* ___

Part A. Writing (6 minutes)

1. Name three American states.
2. What kind of music comes from Nashville, Tennessee?
3. Write three sentences about a singer you like: who he or she is, what he or she looks like, why you like him or her.
4. Look at the poster. Write three sentences: what you see, what colours, your impression.

Part B. Speaking (30 seconds each, in pairs)

Describe the poster to your partner. Then your partner describes it to you.

Student self-correction grid

Criterion	What I did	What I missed (using the teacher's grid)	My improved version
Cultural knowledge			
Description			
Opinion			
Language: vocabulary			
Language: syntax			

Model of an improved version (part A, Q4): In the foreground, Dolly has platinum blonde curls and scarlet lips. The background is pale peach. She is smiling and she looks like a film star, because the colours are brighter than in real life.

Lesson 2. Rags to rhinestones

Debatable question: Can you be proud of where you come from and still reinvent yourself completely?
By the end of this lesson, I can: tell the story of a childhood, talk about past habits, describe an outfit precisely.

Stop point (minute 47). The story of the coat has been told by the class and every student has said one sentence.

Emergency exit (8 minutes). Play only the song (3:04) with the gap task, then a "one sentence each" chain story of the coat in the past simple. Dictate the written record.

Step 1. Recap

1. Give three colours from the Warhol portrait.
2. Complete: *She looks ... a film star.*
3. Give the comparative of *bright* and *colourful*.

Two students read their "Guess who" description; the class guesses.

Step 2. The question of the day

Write on the board: **"It costs a lot of money to look this cheap."** (Dolly Parton). Ask: What is surprising in this sentence? Can a person who grew up poor be proud of it and still wear rhinestones?

Transition. To answer, we need her story: where did she come from?

Step 3. Documents

Document 1. Her childhood (reading)

Dolly Rebecca Parton was born on 19 January 1946 in Locust Ridge, in the Great Smoky Mountains of East Tennessee. She was the fourth of twelve children. Her parents were farmers and the family lived in a one-room cabin. Her father could not read. Her mother sang old ballads and church songs, and music was everywhere in the family. In 1964, the day after she finished high school, she left for Nashville to become a singer.

Reading task. Find: her date of birth · the number of children in the family · the type of house · the city where she went in 1964.

Document 2. Coat of Many Colors (song, 1971)

Watch or listen: Dolly Parton, *Coat Of Many Colors* (Official Audio), Dolly Parton channel: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KFbYFHaigSk
Play from 0:00 to 3:04 (whole track, 3 minutes 4 seconds).

Before listening (summary to read). One autumn, her mother had no money for a coat, so she made one with scraps of fabric. As she sewed, she told Dolly the Bible story of Joseph and his coat of many colours. Dolly was proud of her coat, but at school the other children laughed at her. Years later, Dolly wrote a song about that day. It reached number 4 in the American country charts in 1971, and Dolly always said it was her favourite song.

Task during listening (first time). Tick the words you hear: *rags · colours · mother · money · school · city · proud · rich · happy · coat*.

Task during listening (second time, from 1:30 to 3:04). Answer: How did the children react? How did Dolly feel? What does she say about being "rich"?

(Teacher's note: the lyrics are protected by copyright; do not hand out the full lyrics. Use the summary above and short quotations only.)

Document 3. Dolly on her look

Quotation	Source
"It costs a lot of money to look this cheap."	Dolly Parton; she confirmed this famous line to *USA Today* (21 February 2024)
"I'm not offended by all the dumb blonde jokes because I know I'm not dumb, and I'm not blonde either."	quoted by the BBC and *The Guardian* (2026)
"I look so totally artificial but I am so totally real."	CBS News, 2003

She described her style as "a country girl's idea of glam" (quoted by *People*).

Reading task. In each quotation, find the contrast. **

Step 4. Expanding your vocabulary: the Dolly look

A. Theme vocabulary

Field	Words
Hair and wigs	a wig, a hairpiece, big hair, curls, waves, bouffant, volume, platinum, bleached, teased, an updo
Bling	rhinestones, sequins, glitter, sparkle, beads, studs, jewels, hoop earrings
Make-up	foundation, blush, lipstick, eyeshadow, eyeliner, false lashes, nail polish, long nails
Clothes	a rhinestone suit, a jumpsuit, a gown, fringe, high heels, cowboy boots, patchwork, rags, tight, flashy
Colours and shades	hot pink, baby blue, gold, silver, ivory, pastel, bright, pale, shiny, sparkly
Opinion	glamorous, over the top, eye-catching, tacky, elegant, bold, timeless
Story	to grow up, a cabin, a farmer, poor, scraps of fabric, to sew, to laugh at someone, to be proud of

B. Words to tell a story and argue

Function	Words
Order events	first, then, after that, one day, years later, finally
Contrast	but, although, even if, in spite of + noun
Cause and consequence	because, so, that's why, as a result
Opinion with nuance	I think her look is a bit over the top, but... · It may look tacky, yet...

Exercises on vocabulary

Exercise B1. Sort the words into the right field: sequins, wig, blush, gown, curls, glitter, eyeliner, cowboy boots.

Exercise B2. Fill in the gaps with: proud · scraps · laughed · grew up · sewed
Dolly (1) **__ in a cabin. Her mother (2) _** ***a coat with (3) of fabric. The children (4) at her, but she was (5)*** ___ of her coat.

Exercise B3. Opposites. Match: 1 tacky · 2 poor · 3 artificial · 4 pale
a. real · b. elegant · c. bright · d. rich

Flashcards

Front	Back
rags (blue)	old torn clothes, haillons · *The children said her coat was made of rags.*
although (green)	bien que · *Although she grew up poor, she became a star.* · al-THOUGH
used to + base verb (red)	habit in the past · *She used to sing with her mother.*

Step 5. The teacher's point

Teacher script. Tell the story of the coat with the class, one sentence each. Write regular and irregular verbs in two columns. Then show how *used to* describes a habit, not a single event. End with the adjective order line and build one outfit description together.

Point	Form	Examples
Past simple, regular	verb + -ed	live → lived, laugh → laughed, use → used
Past simple, irregular	to learn	be → was/were, grow → grew, make → made, wear → wore, write → wrote, sing → sang, leave → left
Negative and question	didn't + base verb; Did + subject + base verb?	She didn't have a coat. Did the children laugh? Yes, they did.
used to + base verb	a past habit or state	She used to sing with her mother. She didn't use to wear wigs as a child.
Order of adjectives	opinion → size → age → shape → colour → material + noun	a beautiful long pink satin dress; big blonde curls

Quick check. Put in order: *dress / pink / a / sparkly / long* → **a long sparkly pink dress** (a sparkly long pink dress is also accepted: sparkly can be read as an opinion).

Step 6. Exercises

Exercise 1. Find the past forms of these verbs in Documents 1 and 2: be, live, sing, make, tell, laugh, write, leave.

Exercise 2. Put the story in order.
a. The children laughed at her. b. Her mother made a coat with scraps of fabric. c. Years later, she wrote a song about it. d. Dolly wore her coat to school. e. The family had no money for a coat.

Exercise 3. used to.
1. The family (live) ... in a one-room cabin. 2. Her mother (sing) ... old ballads. 3. The children (not / have) ... new clothes. 4. Dolly (dream) ... of becoming a star.

Exercise 4. Describe the outfit (adjective order).
1. a (pink / sparkly / long) gown 2. a (white / beautiful / fringe) jacket 3. (big / blonde / curly) hair 4. (red / high / shiny) heels

Exercise 5. Transform into questions in the past simple.
1. She grew up in Tennessee. (Where...?) 2. Her mother made the coat. (Who...?) 3. She left for Nashville in 1964. (When...?)

Exercise 6. Short production (8 sentences). Four sentences about Dolly as a child (past simple and used to), four about her stage look. Give your opinion with one adjective from the Opinion line and one contrast word.
Model answer: As a child, Dolly lived in a cabin. She used to wear clothes made by her mother. One autumn, her

mother sewed a coat with scraps of fabric. The children laughed at her. Later, she wore big platinum wigs and sparkly rhinestone suits. Although her look was over the top, it was glamorous. She never hid where she came from. I think she was proud of her roots and free to reinvent herself.

Help box. Frame: *When she was a child, she lived... She used to... Later, she wore a ... ... (opinion, colour, material) ...*
Going further. Explain the joke in 60 words: *It costs a lot of money to look this cheap.* Start: *I think she means that... This joke shows that...*
Possible answer: I think she means that her look seems cheap and flashy, but in fact wigs, rhinestones and stage make-up are very expensive. The joke shows that she was not ashamed of her style: she laughed at it first, so the critics could not hurt her.

Step 7. Speaking task: "Then and now"

1. **Chain story (whole class, 4 min).** Each student says one sentence of Dolly's childhood in the past simple; the next student must start with a connector (then, after that, one day, years later).
2. **Mini-debate in pairs (5 min).** Student A: "She was proud of where she came from." Student B: "She reinvented herself completely." Each student speaks for one minute with two arguments, then they agree on a nuanced sentence with *although*.

Possible nuanced sentence: Although she reinvented her look, she stayed proud of her roots: her favourite song is about a coat made of rags.

Step 8. Written record

> ***Lesson 2. Rags to rhinestones***
> *Dolly grew up poor in a one-room cabin in Tennessee. Her mother made her a coat of many colours with scraps of fabric; the children laughed at her. In 1971, Dolly turned this memory into a song. Later, she built a famous look: big platinum wigs, rhinestones, long nails.*
> ***Grammar.*** *Past simple for finished events (she grew up, she wrote). used to + verb for past habits. Order of adjectives: opinion, size, age, shape, colour, material + noun.*
> ***My answer:*** *Although she ..., she ...*

Step 9. Homework

1. Make six flashcards (two from the Hair line, two from Bling, one green, one red). Revise last lesson's cards.
2. Present one stage outfit of Dolly in 60 words (adjective order + past simple), with a photo from an official website (link only).
3. Help box: record a 45-second oral description of your outfit.

Lesson 3. Backstage: three role-plays

Debatable question: Who really makes a star: the star or the team?
By the end of this lesson, I can: ask for something, offer help, make a suggestion, say no politely and pay a compliment in a professional situation.

Stop point (minute 46). Every pair has played at least once.

Emergency exit (8 minutes). Pairs play a short version (four lines) of Scene 1 using only the five lines of useful phrases. Two pairs perform in front of the class.

Step 1. Recap

1. Give two words for hair and two words for bling. 2. Put in order: *dress / sparkly / pink / a*. 3. Past simple of make, wear, write.

Step 2. The question of the day

Ask: Before a concert, who works with the star? Make a list on the board (dresser, hairdresser, wig maker, make-up artist, sound engineer, lighting technician, stage manager...). Then: *Who really makes a star: the star or the team?* Students vote with a show of hands and keep their vote for the end of the lesson.

Transition. At work, we must speak politely to the boss and to colleagues. Today, you play the team.

Step 3. Expanding your vocabulary

A. The backstage team

Word	Meaning	Example
a dresser	the person who helps an artist dress and change costumes	The dresser prepares the quick change.
a hairdresser / a wig stylist	the person who styles hair or wigs	The wig stylist adds volume.
a make-up artist	the person who does professional make-up	The make-up artist chooses colours for the lights.
a fitting	trying on a garment to adjust it	The fitting is at six.
a quick change	a very fast change of costume during a show	She has a quick change after song three.
stage lights	the strong lights of the stage	Under the stage lights, colours look paler.
a dressing room	the room where artists get ready	Her dressing room is full of wigs.

B. Useful phrases (to interact)

Function	Useful phrases
Requests	Could you...? · Can I have...? · Could you make it a bit more...?
Offers	Would you like me to...? · Shall I...? · Do you want me to...?
Suggestions	What about...? · Why don't we...? · It might look better if...
Polite disagreement	I'm not sure about... · I'd rather... · I see what you mean, but...
Compliments	I love the way... · That looks amazing! · You look fabulous!

Exercises on vocabulary

Exercise C1. Who says it? dresser, hairdresser or make-up artist?
1. "Close your eyes, I'm doing your eyeliner." 2. "I'll take it in at the waist." 3. "Shall I add more volume on top?"

Exercise C2. Fill in the gaps: fitting · quick change · dressing room · stage lights
Dolly is in her (1) **__. The (2) _** ***is at six. After song three, she has a (3) of two minutes. The colours must be strong for the (4)*** **___.**

Flashcards

Front	Back
a quick change (blue)	changement rapide · *She has a quick change after song three.*
I'd rather + base verb (red)	je préférerais · *I'd rather wear the white one.* · I'd = I would
I see what you mean, but... (green)	je comprends, mais... · polite disagreement

Step 4. The teacher's point

Teacher script. Mime a situation with a student: you are the hairdresser, the student is Dolly. Make an offer, a suggestion, then accept a polite refusal. Students note the phrases; sort them into five lines on the board.

Point	Form	Example
Requests	Could you + base verb? (more polite than Can you)	Could you make it a bit shorter?
Offers	Would you like me to + base verb? · Shall I + base verb?	Shall I add more volume?
Suggestions	What about + noun / verb-ing? · Why don't we + base verb? · It might look better if + present or past simple	What about the pink suit?
Preferences	I'd rather + base verb · I'd prefer + noun	I'd rather wear the white one.
Nuance	a bit more / a bit less + adjective	a bit higher, a bit less glitter

Quick check. Make it more polite: *Give me the pink one.* → **Could you give me the pink one, please?**

Step 5. Exercises

Exercise 1. Request, offer, suggestion, disagreement or compliment?
1. Shall I add some glitter? 2. I'm not sure about the green. 3. Could you make it a bit tighter? 4. What about false

lashes? 5. I love the way it shines.

Exercise 2. Complete the dialogue with: Shall I · I'd rather · Could you · What about · I love
A: ... the white dress? B: Hmm, ... wear the pink one. A: OK. ... take it in at the waist? B: Yes, please. ... make it a bit shorter too? A: Of course. B: ... the way you work!

Exercise 3. Make these sentences polite.
1. Add hairspray. 2. I want the golden wig. 3. No, not the green eyeshadow. 4. Do it faster.

Exercise 4. Offer or suggestion? Transform.
1. I'll add more volume. → (Shall I...?) 2. We use a zip. → (Why don't we...?) 3. The pink lipstick. → (What about...?)

Step 6-7. The three backstage role-plays

Work in pairs. One student plays Dolly, the other plays the professional. Prepare for five minutes with your card, play for two or three minutes, then change roles. Use the Help or Going further starters if you need them.

Scene 1. Dolly and her dresser

Situation. Twenty minutes before the show. Dolly tries on her stage costume. There is a quick change between two songs: she has less than two minutes to change outfits.

Role card A · Dolly
1. Choose between the pink rhinestone suit and the white fringe dress.
2. Ask for one change (shorter, tighter, more sparkle).
3. Check that the quick change is possible.
4. Pay a compliment at the end.

Role card B · The dresser
1. Show two outfits and describe them (adjective order).
2. Check the size and the shoes.
3. Suggest a zip or Velcro for the quick change.
4. Accept or politely disagree with Dolly's ideas.

Help (both roles): I want... · I like... · It's too... · Do you want...? · Here is...
Core: Could you make it a bit more...? · I'd rather... · Would you like me to...? · Shall I...?
Going further: It might look better if... · For the quick change, I'd suggest... · If we use a zip instead of buttons, you'll...

Professional words: fitting, costume, rhinestone suit, sequins, fringe, hem, zip, seam, to take in, to let out, quick change, rack, steamer, safety pin.

Model dialogue (read it after your own performance)
Dresser: Here are your two outfits: the pink rhinestone suit and the white fringe dress.
Dolly: Oh, I love the pink one! Could you make the jacket a bit tighter?
Dresser: Of course. Shall I take it in at the waist?
Dolly: Yes, please. And the quick change, is it possible in two minutes?
Dresser: It might be faster if we use a zip instead of buttons.
Dolly: Good idea. I'd rather have a zip, then. You're a star!

Scene 2. Dolly and her hairdresser

Situation. Dolly chooses a wig for the concert. The hairdresser styles it and adds volume. The stage lights are very bright.

Role card A · Dolly
1. Say what kind of hair you want tonight (big, curly, platinum).

2. Ask for more volume or softer curls.
3. Politely refuse one suggestion.
4. Thank the hairdresser.

Role card B · The hairdresser
1. Show two wigs and describe them.
2. Suggest a style for the outfit and the lights.
3. Explain what you are doing (curling, teasing, spraying).
4. Check that Dolly is happy.

Help: I want big hair. · Not this one. · Do you like...? · More or less?
Core: Could you make it a bit higher? · I'd rather have... · Would you like me to add...? · What about curls?
Going further: I'm not sure about the colour, could we...? · Under the stage lights, a lighter shade would... · I'd recommend...

Professional words: wig, hairpiece, wig cap, styling, volume, curls, waves, teasing, hairspray, hairpins, bleached, highlights, shade, platinum, golden.

Model dialogue
Hairdresser: Would you like the platinum wig or the golden one tonight?
Dolly: The platinum one, please. The bigger the better!
Hairdresser: Shall I add more volume on top?
Dolly: Yes, and could you make the curls a bit softer?
Hairdresser: Sure. Under the stage lights, a little hairspray will keep them in place.
Dolly: I love the way it shines. Thank you, honey!

Scene 3. Dolly and her make-up artist

Situation. The make-up artist prepares Dolly's stage make-up. The colours must be strong enough for the lights and the cameras.

Role card A · Dolly
1. Choose the colours for your eyes and your lips.
2. Ask for false lashes.
3. Ask for more sparkle, or less.
4. Pay a compliment.

Role card B · The make-up artist
1. Explain the steps (foundation, eyes, lips) with First I'll..., then I'll...
2. Suggest colours that work under the lights.
3. Ask Dolly to close her eyes, look up, and so on.
4. Check the result with Dolly.

Help: I want... · More colour, please. · Close your eyes, please. · Do you like...?
Core: Could you make it a bit more...? · Would you like me to...? · What about a pink lipstick?
Going further: That's lovely, but maybe... · Under the lights, this shade will... · I'd suggest a lighter...

Professional words: foundation, concealer, contouring, highlighter, blush, eyeshadow, eyeliner, mascara, false lashes, lip liner, lipstick, stage make-up, setting spray, glitter.

Model dialogue
Make-up artist: First I'll put on the foundation, then we'll do the eyes.
Dolly: Lovely. I'd like lilac eyeshadow, like on the Warhol portrait.
Make-up artist: Good choice. Would you like me to add false lashes?
Dolly: Yes, please! And could you make the lips a bit brighter?
Make-up artist: What about this red? Under the lights, it will look perfect.
Dolly: I love the way you work. I'm ready for the show!

Peer assessment grid for the role-plays

Criterion	Not yet	Nearly	Reached	Beyond
Interaction: I react and keep the conversation going	I read my card only	short answers	I answer and ask questions	I react to everything, suggest and negotiate
Polite requests, offers, suggestions	none	Can I / I want	Could you / Would you like me to / What about	It might look better if / I'd rather / Would it be possible
Professional vocabulary	fewer than 3 words	3 to 5 words	6 to 9 words	10 words or more, used precisely
Pronunciation and fluency	hard to understand	understandable with pauses	clear, few pauses	clear and natural, good intonation
Language: vocabulary reused and syntax	many errors	some errors in questions	questions and modals correct	varied and correct

Back to the vote. After the role-plays, ask again: *Who makes a star?* Students explain if they changed their vote. **Possible answer:** I changed my mind: without the dresser, the quick change is impossible, so the team makes the star possible, but the star makes the choices.

Step 8. Written record

> ***Lesson 3. Backstage***
> *Behind a star, there is a team: a dresser, a hairdresser or wig stylist, a make-up artist.*
> *To be polite at work: request = Could you...?; offer = Shall I...? / Would you like me to...?; suggestion = What about...? / Why don't we...?; preference = I'd rather...; disagreement = I'm not sure about...; compliment = I love the way...*
> ***My answer:*** *I think the star / the team... because...*

Step 9. Homework

1. Write the dialogue you played (ten lines), or record it.
2. Learn the five lines of useful phrases with flashcards (one red card per line).
3. Help box: learn three polite phrases by heart and say them to someone at home.

Passing the torch. Dolly gave young artists advice. Miley Cyrus remembered this one: "You do you, I'll do me, and together we'll be us." (reported by Billboard, 2025). What advice would you give a young colleague before a first day at work?

Lesson 4. 9 to 5: working women

Debatable question: Can a pop song change the way people see work?
By the end of this lesson, I can: describe a working day, say what is fair and unfair at work, explain rules and give advice.

Stop point (minute 47). Every student has said one rule for a fair workplace.

Emergency exit (8 minutes). Play the video once (0:00 to 2:34) with the verb task, then each student says one sentence with *mustn't* or *don't have to* about their work placement.

Step 1. Recap

1. Make it polite: *Give me the wig.* 2. Complete: ... *I add more volume?* (offer) 3. Give one compliment.

Step 2. The question of the day

Ask: Name a song about work, school or money. Do songs change anything, or are they just entertainment?

Transition. In 1980, Dolly wrote a song for a film about three office workers. It became an anthem. Let's see why.

Step 3. Documents

Document 1. The film and the song (reading)

9 to 5 (1980) was Dolly Parton's first film. She played Doralee, a secretary, with Jane Fonda and Lily Tomlin. The three women work for a sexist boss who steals their ideas and refuses to give them a promotion. The title echoes 9to5, an organisation of women office workers created in Boston in 1973 to fight for fair pay and respect.

Dolly wrote the song during the shooting. She used her long acrylic nails to imitate the sound of a typewriter. The song reached number one in the pop and country charts, was nominated for an Oscar (Best Original Song) and won two Grammy Awards.

Reading task. True or false? Justify.
1. Dolly played the boss. 2. The boss is fair. 3. The song won an Oscar. 4. Dolly used her nails as an instrument.

Video. 9 to 5 (Official Video)

Watch or listen: Dolly Parton, *9 To 5* (Official Video), Dolly Parton channel: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UbxUSsFXYo4
Play from 0:00 to 2:34 (the whole clip). Watch twice.

Task 1 (first viewing, 0:00 to 0:33). Tick the verbs you hear: *tumble, stumble, pour, yawn, stretch, cook, jump, drive*.

Task 2 (second viewing, 0:33 to 1:25). Note three complaints of the worker.

Task 3 (1:25 to 2:34). What changes in the last part? **

(Teacher's note: lyrics are protected by copyright. Quote one line at most; never hand out the full lyrics.)

Step 4. Expanding your vocabulary

A. Work and rights

Word	Meaning	Example
an office worker	a person who works in an office	Doralee is an office worker.
a boss / a manager	the person in charge	The boss is sexist.
a promotion	a better job in the same company	Violet wants a promotion.
equal pay	the same salary for the same work	Women fight for equal pay.
to get credit for	to be recognised for your work	They never get credit for their ideas.
harassment	repeated behaviour that upsets or threatens someone	Sexual harassment is illegal.
a shift	a period of work	I work the morning shift.
overtime	extra hours of work	Overtime must be paid.
a colleague	a person you work with	The three colleagues become friends.
a union	an organisation that defends workers	You can contact a union representative.
fair / unfair	just / not just	It is unfair to steal ideas.

B. Words to argue

Function	Words
Give an opinion	I believe that... · As far as I'm concerned,...
Agree / disagree	I agree with... · I don't agree because... · That's true, but...
Add an argument	Moreover,... · What's more,... · Besides,...
Conclude	To sum up,... · All in all,...

Exercises on vocabulary

Exercise D1. Fair or unfair? 1 equal pay · 2 unpaid overtime · 3 a boss who steals ideas · 4 a promotion for good work · 5 harassment

Exercise D2. Fill in the gaps: credit · shift · overtime · union · colleague
I work the night (1) **__. Last week I did ten hours of (2) _,** ***but they were not paid. My (3) told me to contact the (4) . I also want to get (5)*** ___ for my ideas.

Exercise D3. Reformulate with *Moreover* or *To sum up*.
1. The boss is rude. He steals ideas. → 2. Women are underpaid, harassed and never promoted: the office is unfair. →

Flashcards

Front	Back
equal pay (blue)	égalité salariale · *Women fight for equal pay.*
mustn't vs don't have to (red)	interdit / pas obligatoire · *You mustn't smoke. You don't have to come early.*
Moreover, (green)	de plus · *Moreover, he steals their ideas.*

Step 5. The teacher's point

Teacher script. Read the first words of the song and list the routine verbs. Then show the difference between *don't have to* (it is not necessary) and *mustn't* (it is forbidden), with examples from the students' work placements.

Point	Form	Example
Present simple for routines		She gets up at seven. She pours a cup of coffee.
Frequency adverbs	before the main verb, after be: always, usually, often, sometimes, rarely, never	She always works late. The boss is never polite.
have to / must	obligation	Workers have to respect safety rules. You must wear your badge.
don't have to	no obligation	You don't have to work on Sundays.
mustn't	prohibition	A boss mustn't harass his staff.
should	advice	You should talk to a union representative.

Quick check. *You (mustn't / don't have to) work on public holidays, but you can if you want.* → **don't have to**.

Step 6. Exercises

Exercise 1. Where does the adverb go?
1. Doralee arrives on time. (always) 2. The boss says thank you. (never) 3. Violet is tired. (often) 4. They work late. (sometimes)

Exercise 2. Rules at work: have to · don't have to · mustn't · should
1. You ... wear safety shoes in a workshop. 2. A boss ... steal his employees' ideas. 3. You ... come in early, but it is appreciated. 4. If you have a problem, you ... talk to your tutor.

Exercise 3. Match the situation and the rule.
1. Using your phone near a machine · 2. Wearing a uniform in a hotel · 3. Working on your day off · 4. Feeling stressed
a. You should talk to your manager. b. You don't have to. c. You mustn't. d. You have to.

Exercise 4. Transform with the word in brackets.
1. It is forbidden to shout at customers. (mustn't) 2. It is not necessary to bring lunch. (don't have to) 3. It's a good idea to ask questions. (should)

Exercise 5. My working day (70 words) in your pathway with five frequency adverbs, then three rules for a fair workplace (have to, mustn't, should).
Model answer: I am a sales assistant. I usually start at nine. I always check the shelves first, then I often help customers. I sometimes work late on Saturdays and I rarely have lunch before two. My tutor is never rude. Rules: Employees have to respect customers. A manager mustn't shout at the staff. Everybody should get credit for good ideas.

Help box. Frame: *I am a... I always... I usually... I sometimes... I never... You have to... You mustn't... You should...*
Going further. Compare 1980 and today (80 words): *In 1980, women often used to... Today, they still... / no longer...*
Possible answer: In 1980, women office workers often used to earn less than men and rarely got promotions. Many were harassed and could not complain. Today, the law forbids discrimination and harassment, and companies have to publish equality figures in some countries. However, women still earn less on average and they are still under-represented in top jobs. So the song is still relevant.

Step 7. Speaking task: "The workers' meeting"

Groups of four: you are colleagues in Doralee's office. Each student has one card.

1. **Card 1:** describe a typical unfair day (frequency adverbs).
2. **Card 2:** propose two rules with *have to* and *mustn't*.
3. **Card 3:** give advice to a new colleague with *should*.
4. **Card 4:** answer the question of the day: *Can a pop song change the way people see work?* Use *Moreover* and *To sum up*.

Then one spokesperson per group presents the group's three best rules to the class (30 seconds).

Possible answer for card 4: I believe a song cannot change a law, but it can change how people see their job. Moreover, *9 to 5* gave office workers a voice: they sang it together. To sum up, a song is not a revolution, but it can start a conversation.

Step 8. Written record

> ***Lesson 4. 9 to 5***
> *In 9 to 5 (1980), Dolly played Doralee, a secretary with a sexist boss. Her song reached number one, was nominated for an Oscar and won two Grammys. It became an anthem for office workers.*
> ***Grammar.*** *Frequency adverbs before the verb, after be. have to / must = obligation; don't have to = not necessary; mustn't = forbidden; should = advice.*
> ***My answer:*** *A song can / cannot change... because...*

Step 9. Homework

1. Revise all flashcards from Lessons 1 to 4 (the mid-point assessment is next lesson).
2. Write five rules for a fair workplace in your future job.
3. Help box: record yourself saying your five rules (one minute).

Passing the torch. In 2009, *9 to 5: The Musical*, with songs by Dolly, opened on Broadway. What has changed at work since 1980? What is still the same?

Lesson 5. Dollywood: a business and an employer

Debatable question: Is a theme park a gift to a region or simply a business?
By the end of this lesson, I can: present a company, its history and its numbers, and apply for a seasonal job.

Stop point (minute 35). Start the assessment at minute 35 at the latest.

Emergency exit (8 minutes). If the assessment must be postponed: one interview question per student ("Why do you want to work at Dollywood?"), then the assessment opens the next lesson.

Step 1. Recap

1. Explain: *You mustn't* / *You don't have to*. 2. Two words about work. 3. Who did Dolly play in *9 to 5*?

Step 2. The question of the day

Ask: Would you like a big theme park near your town? What would it bring? What problems could it create (traffic, prices, seasonal jobs)?

Transition. Dolly opened a theme park near the mountains where she grew up. Let's look at the numbers before we judge.

Step 3. Document. Dollywood in numbers

Dollywood opened on 3 May 1986 in Pigeon Forge, Tennessee, close to the mountains where Dolly grew up. She became a partner of an existing park and created Dollywood with Herschend Family Entertainment, which still runs it. Today, the Dollywood company includes a theme park, a water park, resorts, restaurants and shops.

Fact	Figure
Opening	3 May 1986
Employees	about 4,000 to 4,500, the largest employer in Sevier County (as reported by WATE and CNN Business)
Visitors	about 3 million a year (as reported by WATE)
Jobs	ride operators, lifeguards, chefs, housekeepers, sales assistants, security staff, musicians

Dolly's coat of many colours is displayed in a museum inside the park (BBC Culture). Official job page: Dollywood Jobs.

In 1988, Dolly also created the Dollywood Foundation to fight the high school dropout rate in Sevier County (Knox News, 2026).

Reading task. Find: the date of opening · the town · the partner company · two jobs · one fact that shows the park is important for the region.

Step 4. Expanding your vocabulary

A. The company

Word	Meaning	Example
a theme park	a park with rides and shows on a theme	Dollywood is a theme park.
a resort	a hotel with many activities	The park has resorts.
an employer	a company that gives jobs	Dollywood is the largest employer in the county.
staff	all the people who work for a company	The staff wear name badges.
a seasonal job	a job for one season	Many students take seasonal jobs.
a job fair / a hiring event	a day when a company meets candidates	Dollywood organises hiring events.
to apply for a job	to ask officially for a job	I want to apply for a job as a lifeguard.
customer service	helping customers	Customer service is important in a park.
tourism	travelling for pleasure, and the industry around it	Tourism is a big business in Tennessee.
a local economy	the jobs and businesses of a region	The park helps the local economy.

B. Words to weigh pros and cons

Function	Words
Advantages	One advantage is that... · It brings... · Thanks to...
Disadvantages	One drawback is that... · The problem is that...
Balance	On the one hand,... On the other hand,... · Even so,...

Exercises on vocabulary

Exercise E1. Jobs and places. 1 ride operator · 2 lifeguard · 3 chef · 4 housekeeper · 5 sales assistant / a the water park · b the gift shop · c the roller coaster · d the restaurant · e the resort rooms

Exercise E2. Advantage or drawback? 1 thousands of jobs · 2 traffic jams · 3 seasonal contracts only · 4 money for local shops

Flashcards

Front	Back
an employer (blue)	employeur · *Dollywood is the largest employer in the county.* · em-PLOY-er
since / for (red)	since + starting point, for + duration · *since 1986, for forty years*
On the one hand... on the other hand... (green)	d'un côté... de l'autre...

Step 5. The teacher's point

Teacher script. Draw a timeline from 1986 to today. Put *opened* on the 1986 point (past simple) and an arrow from 1986 to today for *has created* (present perfect). Practise reading numbers aloud.

Point	Form	Example
Past simple: finished time		Dollywood opened in 1986.
Present perfect: result today, period up to now	have/has + past participle	The park has created thousands of jobs. Millions of people have visited it.
since / for	since + starting point; for + duration	It has existed since 1986. It has existed for forty years.
Big numbers	no -s after hundred, thousand, million with a number	4,500 = four thousand five hundred; 3,000,000 = three million
Years		1986 = nineteen eighty-six; 2026 = twenty twenty-six

Quick check. Correct: *Dollywood has opened in 1986.* → **Dollywood opened in 1986.** (finished date: past simple)

Step 6. Exercises

Exercise 1. Read the numbers aloud, then write them: 1986 · 4,000 · 4,500 · 3,000,000.

Exercise 2. Past simple or present perfect?
1. Dollywood (open) ... in 1986. 2. Since then, the park (grow) ... a lot. 3. Millions of visitors (come) ... to Pigeon Forge. 4. In 1988, Dolly (create) ... the Dollywood Foundation. 5. The park (exist) ... for forty years.

Exercise 3. since or for? 1 ... 1986 · 2 ... two years · 3 ... last summer · 4 ... a long time

Exercise 4. A short application (70 words). Email to apply for a seasonal job at Dollywood: the job, what you have done (present perfect), your availability, why you want the job.
Model answer: Dear Sir or Madam, I would like to apply for a job as a sales assistant this summer. I have studied retail for two years and I have done two work placements in shops. I have always enjoyed working with customers. I am available from June to August. I love music and I would be proud to work in a park created by Dolly Parton. Yours faithfully, ...

Help box. Frame: *Dear Sir or Madam, I would like to apply for a job as... I have studied... for... years. I have worked in... I am available from... to... Yours faithfully,*

Step 7. Speaking task: "The job interview"

Pairs: student A is the recruiter, student B is the candidate. Then swap.

Recruiter's questions:
1. Why do you want to work at Dollywood?
2. What have you learnt in your training?
3. How long have you studied your trade?
4. How would you deal with an angry customer?

Going further. The recruiter adds: *Do you think Dollywood is good for the region?* The candidate answers with *On the one hand... on the other hand...*

Possible answer: On the one hand, Dollywood has created thousands of jobs in a poor region. On the other hand, many jobs are seasonal and tourism brings traffic. Even so, I think it is more a gift than a simple business, because Dolly chose her home county.

Step 8. Mid-point assessment (Lessons 1-4 and 5)

Student sheet

Name: __ Class: _ *Date:* ___ (15 minutes)

Part A. Reading (6 points)

> *Dolly Parton grew up in a one-room cabin in Tennessee. She was the fourth of twelve children. Her mother made her a coat with scraps of fabric, and the children at school laughed at her. In 1971, Dolly wrote a song about this coat. Later, she became famous for her big platinum wigs and her rhinestone suits. In 1980, she played a secretary in the film 9 to 5 and wrote the title song, which won two Grammy Awards. In 1986, she opened Dollywood, which has become the largest employer in her county.*

1. How many children were there in the family? (1)
2. Why did the children laugh at Dolly? (1)
3. Give two elements of her famous look. (1)
4. What job did she play in *9 to 5*? (1)
5. Find one verb in the past simple and one in the present perfect. (1)
6. True or false: Dollywood has created few jobs. Justify. (1)

Part B. Language (6 points)

1. Correct: *She is having blonde hair.* (1)
2. Put in order: *gown / long / a / pink / sparkly* (1)
3. Complete with used to: *Her mother (sing) ... ballads.* (1)
4. Make it polite: *Give me the wig.* (1)
5. mustn't or don't have to: *You ... smoke in the workshop.* (1)
6. since or for: *Dollywood has existed ... 1986.* (1)

Part C. Writing (5 points). In 60 to 80 words: describe Dolly's look and say if you think she reinvented herself or stayed the same girl from the mountains. Use at least one comparative, one past simple, one *although*.

Part D. Speaking (3 points, 1 minute with the teacher or recorded): describe the Warhol portrait.

B. 1 She has blonde hair. · 2 a long sparkly pink gown · 3 used to sing · 4 Could you give me the wig, please? · 5 mustn't · 6 since.
C. **Model:** Dolly grew up poor and wore a coat made of scraps of fabric. Later, her look became much brighter than in her childhood: big platinum wigs, rhinestones and long nails. Although she reinvented her image, I think she stayed the same girl from the mountains, because she wrote songs about her childhood and opened her park near her home.

Student self-correction grid

Part	My mark	What I missed (using the teacher's grid)	The rule or word I need	My improved version
A. Reading	/6			
B. Language	/6			
C. Content	/2			
C. Vocabulary	/1			
C. Syntax	/2			
D. Speaking	/3			

Instruction. Rewrite part C completely, following every line of the teacher's grid, and underline the words and structures you have added.

Step 9. Written record and homework

> ***Lesson 5. Dollywood***
> *Dollywood opened in 1986 in Pigeon Forge, Tennessee. It has become the largest employer in Sevier County, with about 4,000 to 4,500 employees and about 3 million visitors a year.*
> ***Grammar.*** *Past simple + finished date (opened in 1986). Present perfect = result today (has created). since + starting point, for + duration.*
> ***My answer:*** *On the one hand... On the other hand...*

Homework.
1. Present a company from your pathway in six sentences (date, number of employees, jobs; one present perfect with since or for).
2. Make five flashcards from this lesson.
3. Help box: record your presentation (one minute).

Passing the torch. Dolly gave jobs to her region. Why do some stars invest in the place where they grew up?

Lesson 6. Aunt Dolly: passing the torch to Miley

Debatable question: What can you really pass on to someone who is not your child?
By the end of this lesson, I can: tell the story of a bond between two people, report what they said, compare two voices.

Stop point (minute 47). Every student has reported one piece of advice.

Emergency exit (8 minutes). Play only Jolene (0:00 to 1:32) with the gap task; then each student reports Dolly's 2009 sentence in reported speech.

Step 1. Recap

1. When did Dollywood open? 2. Complete: *The park has existed ... 1986.* 3. Two jobs at Dollywood.

Step 2. The question of the day

Ask: Who is your godmother, godfather, tutor or mentor? What did this person give you that money cannot buy?

Transition. Dolly had no children, but she had a famous goddaughter. What did she pass on?

Step 3. Documents

Document 1. A godmother (reading)

Miley Cyrus was born in November 1992. She is the daughter of the country singer Billy Ray Cyrus, who worked with Dolly. In a 2009 interview with Robin Roberts on ABC's *Good Morning America*, Dolly explained:

> *"I'm her honorary godmother. I've known her since she was a baby. Her father's a friend of mine, and when she was born, he said, 'You just have to be her godmother,' and I said, 'I accept.'"*
> *(Dolly Parton, Good Morning America, ABC, 2009)*

In the Disney series *Hannah Montana*, Dolly played "Aunt Dolly", Hannah's godmother, in several episodes between 2006 and 2010 (dollyparton.com). In 2024, the genealogy company Ancestry found that they were also distant relatives: seventh cousins once removed (CNN, People).

Shared songs (timeline)
- 2010: Jolene together for the 25th anniversary of Dollywood.
- 2012: Miley sings Jolene in her Backyard Sessions.
- 2016: Jolene on the TV show *The Voice*.
- 2017: *Rainbowland*, written and sung together, on Miley's album *Younger Now*.
- 10 February 2019: Jolene together at the 61st Grammy Awards, during a tribute to Dolly.
- 2023: *Wrecking Ball*, Miley's hit, sung together on Dolly's album *Rockstar*.

Reading task. Who asked Dolly to be the godmother? What does "honorary" mean here? Which song comes back most often in the timeline?

Clip 1. Jolene (Backyard Sessions)

Watch or listen: Miley Cyrus, *The Backyard Sessions*, "Jolene", official Miley Cyrus channel: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wOwblaKmyVw
Play from 0:00 to 1:32.

Task (gap fill while listening).
1. Jolene, Jolene, Jolene, Jolene, I'm ..... of you
2. please don't take my .....
3. Please don't take him even though you .....
4. How many times does she sing the name "Jolene" in the first line?

Context. In *Jolene* (1973), a woman begs a beautiful rival not to take her man. Miley, a young singer, chooses a song written by Dolly fifty years ago: this is one way a song is passed on.

Clip 2. Rainbowland

Watch or listen: Miley Cyrus, *Rainbowland* (feat. Dolly Parton), official Miley Cyrus channel: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GtFw9dEwrbo
Play from 0:00 to 2:00.

Task. 1. Who sings first? 2. Note three words about the world they dream of. 3. Describe the two voices with adjectives: *high, low, soft, husky, bright, powerful, gentle, deep*.
**

Optional (not YouTube): Dolly Parton and Miley Cyrus perform Jolene at the 2019 Grammys, video published by Billboard: https://www.billboard.com/video/dolly-parton-jolene-about-2019-billboard-grammy-awards-coverage-on-billboardgn-sourceflv/ . Task: watch without sound; write three sentences on how they look at each other (proud, tender, playful, close, confident).

Document 2. Advice and tribute

> *"You do you, I'll do me, and together we'll be us."*
> *(Dolly's advice, as reported by Miley Cyrus, Billboard, 2025)*

After Dolly's death, Miley wrote on X (26 August 2026):

> *"The feeling of losing my Aunt Dolly is beyond what feels right to share. Our most sacred moments were private [...] What I KNOW is Dolly would want me to feel it, write a song about it, and then continue on and be strong."*
> *(quoted by Lead Stories, 9 September 2026)*

Reading task. What does "You do you" mean? **

Step 4. Expanding your vocabulary: heritage

Word	Meaning	Example
a godmother / a goddaughter	a woman chosen to support a child / the child	Dolly was Miley's godmother.
honorary	given as an honour, not official	She was her honorary godmother.
a role model	a person you admire and want to copy	Dolly was Miley's role model.
a bond	a strong link between people	They had a real bond.
a mentor	an experienced person who guides you	A tutor can be a mentor.
an heir	a person who receives property when someone dies	Who is Dolly's heir?
a legacy	what a person leaves after their life	Her songs are her legacy.
to look up to	to admire	Miley looked up to Dolly.
to take someone under your wing	to protect and guide someone	Dolly took Miley under her wing.
to pass on / to hand down	to give to the next generation	She passed on her songs.
a cover (version)	a song sung by another artist	Miley's Jolene is a cover.

Words to report and comment: according to... · she claimed that... · she admitted that... · she explained that... · in other words,...

Exercises on vocabulary

Exercise F1. Match. 1 role model · 2 heir · 3 bond · 4 cover / a strong link · b a person you admire · c a song sung by another artist · d a person who inherits

Exercise F2. Fill in the gaps: looked up to · passed on · under her wing · legacy
Miley (1) **__ Dolly. Dolly took her (2) _.** ***She (3) songs and advice. Today, this is part of her (4)*** **___.**

Flashcards

Front	Back
to look up to someone (blue)	admirer · *Miley looked up to Dolly.*
She said (that) + past (red)	"I accept." → *She said that she accepted.*
in other words (green)	autrement dit · *You do you: in other words, be yourself.*

Step 5. The teacher's point

Teacher script. Read Dolly's 2009 quotation aloud. Ask: *What did Billy Ray say? What did Dolly answer?* Write both sentences in reported speech; underline the tense change.

Point	Form	Example
Tense change	present simple → past simple; present continuous → past continuous; will → would	"I am proud." → She said (that) she was proud.
Pronouns and time words	my → her; now → then; today → that day	"my goddaughter" → her goddaughter
say / tell	say something; tell somebody something	She said that... / She told her that...
Orders and advice	tell / advise somebody to + verb	She told her to be herself.
Questions	ask + if / wh-word + normal word order	He asked if she would be her godmother.

Quick check. Report: *"I am so proud of her."* → **She said (that) she was so proud of her.**

Step 6. Exercises

Exercise 1. Who said it? Dolly, Miley or Billy Ray?
1. "You just have to be her godmother." 2. "I accept." 3. "You do you, I'll do me, and together we'll be us." (who reported it to the press?)

Exercise 2. Timeline. 2006 · 2010 · 2017 · 2023 / a Rainbowland · b Aunt Dolly in Hannah Montana · c Wrecking Ball on Rockstar · d Jolene at Dollywood

Exercise 3. Report the words.
1. Dolly: "I am her honorary godmother." → Dolly said that... 2. Dolly to Miley: "Be yourself." → Dolly told Miley... 3. Billy Ray: "Will you be her godmother?" → Billy Ray asked Dolly if... 4. Miley: "I will always love her." → Miley said that...

Exercise 4. say or tell? 1 Dolly ... Miley to be herself. 2 Miley ... that she was heartbroken. 3 Dolly ... the journalist that she had known Miley since she was a baby.

Exercise 5. Report the best advice you have received from an adult, a tutor or a boss (five sentences).
Model answer: My tutor told me to arrive ten minutes early. She said that customers always remembered a smile. She advised me to ask questions. She asked me if I liked the job. She told me not to give up.

Help box. Frames: *He/She told me to... · He/She said that... · He/She asked me if...*
Going further. Use reporting verbs: *advise, encourage, warn, admit, insist*. *Dolly encouraged Miley to follow her own path.* Write an 80-word article: "Dolly and Miley, a family bond".

Step 7. Speaking task: "The best advice I've received"

1. **Pairs (4 min).** Student A tells a piece of advice in direct speech; student B reports it to a third student in reported speech. Swap.
2. **Round table (4 min).** Each student answers the question of the day in one sentence: *What can you pass on to someone who is not your child?* Start with *I think you can pass on...* and give one example from Dolly and Miley.

Possible answer: I think you can pass on songs, values and confidence, but not your talent. Dolly told Miley to be herself, and Miley sang Dolly's songs in her own way.

Step 8. Written record

> ***Lesson 6. Aunt Dolly***
> *Dolly was Miley Cyrus's honorary godmother. They sang Jolene together many times and wrote Rainbowland (2017). Dolly passed on songs and advice: "You do you, I'll do me, and together we'll be us."*
> ***Grammar.*** *Reported speech: the tense goes back (am → was, will → would). say something / tell somebody. tell somebody to + verb. ask if...*
> ***My answer:*** *You can pass on..., but not...*

Step 9. Homework

1. Finish the self-correction of the mid-point assessment (improved version of part C).
2. Make five flashcards from this lesson.
3. Report in five sentences a piece of advice given by an adult or a tutor.
4. Help box: record your five sentences.

Passing the torch. Is a godmother an heir? In which sense? Keep your answer: next lesson starts from it.

Lesson 7. True or Tale? The inheritance rumour

Debatable question: Why do we want to believe a rumour, even when there is no evidence?
By the end of this lesson, I can: say if a piece of information is a verified fact, an unverified claim or a fake, explain why, and quote my sources.

Stop point (minute 47). Every group has given its verdict aloud.

Emergency exit (8 minutes). Read only Document 2. Each student classifies one sentence of Exercise 2 aloud with *must*, *might* or *can't*, then the class writes the verdict together.

Step 1. Recap

1. Report: *"I accept."* (Dolly) 2. Two songs Dolly and Miley sang together. 3. What does an heir receive?

Step 2. The question of the day

Write on the board: **"Dolly Parton left her whole fortune to Miley Cyrus."**

Ask: Have you seen this? Do you believe it? Why would people like this story? Students vote: true / false / we don't know.

Transition. Let's check like journalists: who said it, what is the original source, what do reliable media say?

Step 3. Documents (jigsaw: each student of a group reads one document, then explains it to the other two)

Document 1. The viral video

On 2 September 2026, a YouTube account called @Celebritynews.m posted a video. In it, "Miley Cyrus" seems to explain that her godmother left her entire fortune to her. (We describe the video; we do not show it.)

Document 2. The fact-checkers

According to Lead Stories (9 September 2026), an AI detection tool, Hive Moderation, gave the video a score of 99%: it is very likely AI-generated. The voice is a monotone copy of Miley's voice, without natural changes in emotion or rhythm, and her lips do not always match the words. Read the fact-check: Lead Stories.

Another claim said that Dolly left the rights to *Jolene* to Miley. The site meaww found no credible evidence for it: meaww fact-check.

Document 3. What we know

- No will has been made public (Ridley Law, October 2026).
- According to court documents reported by *The Tennessean* (24 September 2026), Dolly created a trust in 1997, the D.P. Dean Trust, to manage her property after her death. A trust is private, so the public does not know who receives what.
- In 2020, Dolly told Billboard: "I would not want to leave that mess to somebody else."
- Miley's real tribute on X (26 August 2026) said nothing about money: "I will always love her and want to make her proud." (quoted by Lead Stories)
- Dolly's sister, Stella Parton, asked fans to stop sharing fake content: "There is a tremendous amount of AI and endless garbage being posted everyday" (NBC News, September 2026).

Jigsaw task. Each student explains his or her document in French or English (mediation) in one minute, then the group fills in the table.

Who posted it?	Original source?	What reliable media say	What is really known

Step 4. Expanding your vocabulary: fake news

Word	Meaning	Example
a rumour	information that spreads but is not checked	The inheritance story is a rumour.
a fake / a hoax	something false made to trick people	The video is a fake.
a deepfake	a video where AI copies a real person's face or voice	Deepfakes can copy famous voices.
AI-generated	made by artificial intelligence	The voice is AI-generated.
a fact-check	an article that checks a claim	Lead Stories published a fact-check.
a claim	something people say is true	The claim has no source.
evidence (uncountable)	facts that prove something	There is no evidence of the inheritance.
a will	a legal document saying who gets your property	No will was made public.
a trust	a legal structure that manages property, often privately	Her property is managed by a trust.
an inheritance	what you receive when someone dies	The inheritance is private.
reliable / unreliable	that you can / cannot trust	Is this source reliable?
clickbait	content made to attract clicks	Emotional hashtags are typical of clickbait.

Words to talk about sources: According to... · ... reports that... · It is not confirmed. · There is no evidence that... · It has been proved false.

Exercises on vocabulary

Exercise G1. Fill in the gaps: evidence · fact-check · reliable · deepfake · will
The video is a (1) **__. A (2) _** ***by Lead Stories shows it. There is no (3) that Miley inherited everything, and no (4) was made public. Always use (5)*** ___ sources.

Exercise G2. Correct the mistake. 1 *There are no evidences.* 2 *According to me, it's fake.*

Flashcards

Front	Back
evidence (blue)	preuves (indénombrable) · *There is no evidence that she inherited everything.*
It must / might / can't be... (red)	quasi sûr / possible / impossible · *It can't be her real voice.*
According to + source (green)	selon · *According to Lead Stories, the video is fake.*

Step 5. The teacher's point

Teacher script. Draw three columns: Verified fact / Unverified claim / Fake. Read each sentence of Exercise 2 and ask: *How sure are we?* Students answer with must, might or can't before placing the sentence.

Point	Meaning	Example
must + base verb	almost sure it is true	The video must be fake: the lips don't match.
might / may / could	possible	The post might be a joke.
can't	almost sure it is not true	It can't be Miley's real voice: it is too monotone.
must have + past participle (going further)	deduction about the past	Someone must have used AI.
Sources	According to... · There is no evidence that... · It is not confirmed.	
Fact, claim, fake	verified fact = proved by reliable sources; unverified claim = we don't know; fake = proved false	

Quick check. *The trust is private, so the claim (must / might / can't) be true, but nobody can prove it.* → **might**.

Step 6. Exercises

Exercise 1. Signs of an AI video. Tick the warning signs mentioned by Lead Stories.
a monotone voice · lips that don't match the words · an official account · natural emotion in the voice · no reliable media report the story · a link to a court document

Exercise 2. Fact, claim or fake?
1. Dolly was Miley's honorary godmother. 2. Dolly left Jolene to Miley. 3. The video shows the real Miley talking about her inheritance. 4. Dolly died on 25 August 2026. 5. Dolly's will was published. 6. Dolly and Miley sang Jolene together.

Exercise 3. How sure are you?
1. The voice is robotic. It ... be Miley's real voice. 2. No journalist reported it. The story ... be fake. 3. The trust is private. Miley ... be one of the people who inherit, but we can't know.

Exercise 4. The method. Put the questions in a logical order: a. What does the official account say? b. Who posted it? c. Where else is it reported? d. What is the original source?

Exercise 5. Transform with *There is no evidence that...* or *According to...*
1. Nobody can prove that Miley inherited the fortune. 2. Lead Stories says the video is AI-generated.

Exercise 6. Write a fact-check (80 words): the claim, your verdict, three pieces of evidence, your sources.
Model answer: Claim: Dolly Parton left her whole fortune to Miley Cyrus. Verdict: unverified, and the viral video is fake. Evidence: 1. According to Lead Stories, the video is very likely AI-generated (99%). 2. No will has been made public: Dolly's property is managed by a private trust created in 1997. 3. Miley's real tribute on X says nothing about money. Sources: Lead Stories, The Tennessean, meaww.

Help box. Frame: *Claim: ... Verdict: ... According to..., the video... There is no evidence that... Miley's real message...*
Going further. Use impersonal structures: *It is said that... · It is claimed that... · Miley is said to have inherited..., but there is no evidence.*

Step 7. Speaking task: "The newsroom"

Groups of three journalists. Each group prepares a 1-minute TV news flash: "True or Tale?"

1. Presenter 1: the claim and where it appeared.

2. Presenter 2: the evidence (two facts, with According to...).
3. Presenter 3: the verdict with *must*, *might*, *can't*, and an answer to the question of the day: *Why do people want to believe it?*

Possible answer for presenter 3: The video can't be real: the voice is robotic. People might want to believe it because it is a beautiful story: a famous godmother and a famous goddaughter. But a good story is not evidence.

Debate (if time allows). *Is it acceptable to use someone's death to get views online?* Each student says one sentence with *I believe... because....*

Step 8. Written record

> ***Lesson 7. True or Tale?***
> *Claim: "Dolly left everything to Miley." Verdict: unverified. The viral video is very likely AI-generated (Lead Stories). No will has been made public; Dolly's property is managed by a private trust (1997).*
> ***Method:*** *Who posted it? What is the original source? Where else is it reported? What does the official account say?*
> ***Grammar.*** *must = almost sure; might = possible; can't = almost sure it is not true. According to... / There is no evidence that...*

Step 9. Homework

1. Check one viral post of the week with the four questions of the method (five sentences).
2. Make five flashcards about fake news.
3. Help box: record a 30-second verdict on your post with *must*, *might* or *can't*.

Passing the torch. Being a goddaughter gives no automatic right to an inheritance. What we can verify is another heritage: songs, advice, values. Which heritage matters more?

Lesson 8. Dolly's legacy

Debatable question: Is generosity a private choice or a public duty for the very rich?
By the end of this lesson, I can: pay tribute to someone, explain the goal of an action, describe how a programme works, say what will remain.

Stop point (minute 47). Every student has said one sentence of tribute.

Emergency exit (8 minutes). Play the video (0:52 to 3:58) with the passive task, then each student says one purpose sentence (to / so that).

Step 1. Recap

1. Two signs of an AI-generated video. 2. Complete: *There is no ... that Miley inherited the fortune.* 3. Fact, claim or fake: *Dolly left Jolene to Miley.*

Step 2. The question of the day

Ask: If you were very rich, would you have to give money away? Or is it your private choice?

Transition. Dolly gave a lot. Let's see what, how, and why.

Step 3. Documents

Document 1. The announcement

Dolly Rebecca Parton died in Nashville, Tennessee, on 25 August 2026, aged 80 (official announcement on dollyparton.com). According to AP, she died after a brief battle with cancer. Her publicist announced the news in a statement, and her official website published a video message from her nephew Bryan Seaver.

Document 2. The Buddy Program and the Imagination Library

In 1988, Dolly created the Dollywood Foundation in Sevier County, where many students dropped out of high school. Through the Buddy Program, every seventh- and eighth-grade student paired up with a "buddy", and each student who graduated from high school received $500 from Dolly. According to the Dollywood Foundation, the dropout rate for these classes fell from 35% to 6%.

In 1995, Dolly created the Imagination Library as a tribute to her father, who could not read. Every month, registered children receive a book by post, from birth to the age of five, at no cost to families. The programme now works in five countries: the United States, Canada, the United Kingdom, Ireland and Australia. In Europe, it started in Rotherham, England, in 2007 (BBC). More than 330 million books have been sent (CBS 8, 2026), and the programme continues after her death.

Video. The journey of an Imagination Library book

Watch or listen: *The Journey of an Imagination Library Book*, Dolly Parton's Imagination Library channel: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IjxcK1ZZw3c
Play from 0:52 to 3:58 (3 minutes 6 seconds).

Task (while watching). Put the steps in order and note the verb used.
a. The books are mailed by the postal service. b. Titles are selected by a committee. c. Books are printed. d. Each book is labelled and shrink-wrapped. e. Parents register their children.

Document 3. A donation for research

In April 2020, at the start of the COVID-19 pandemic, Dolly gave one million dollars to Vanderbilt University Medical Center in Nashville, in honour of her friend Dr Naji Abumrad. According to Vanderbilt, the Dolly Parton COVID-19 Research Fund contributed to early research linked to the Moderna vaccine (VUMC).

Reading task. For each action, find the year and the goal.

Step 4. Expanding your vocabulary: generosity and memory

Word	Meaning	Example
to pass away	to die (polite)	Dolly passed away in 2026.
a tribute	words or actions to honour someone	Miley wrote a tribute.
a charity	an organisation that helps people	The Dollywood Foundation is a charity.
a donation / to donate	money given to help / to give	She donated a million dollars.
a philanthropist	a rich person who gives to good causes	Dolly was a philanthropist.
literacy	the ability to read and write	The library helps literacy.
to drop out (of school)	to leave school without a diploma	Many students used to drop out.
research	scientific work	Her money helped vaccine research.
to give back	to help the community that helped you	Dolly wanted to give back.
to live on	to continue to exist	Her music will live on.
at no cost to	without paying anything	Books are sent at no cost to families.

Words to argue about duty and choice: It is up to each person to... · Society expects... · It is a moral duty to... · Nobody can force someone to... · It depends on...

Exercises on vocabulary

Exercise H1. Match. 1 literacy · 2 to drop out · 3 a donation · 4 to live on / a money given · b to continue to exist · c reading and writing · d to leave school

Exercise H2. Fill in the gaps: philanthropist · give back · at no cost · tribute
Dolly was a great (1) **__. She wanted to (2) _** ***to her region. Children receive books (3) to families. This lesson is a (4)*** ___ to her.

Flashcards

Front	Back
literacy (blue)	alphabétisation, capacité à lire et écrire · *The library helps literacy.* · LI-te-ra-cy
so that + subject + could (red)	pour que · *She created the library so that children could read.*
It is up to each person to... (green)	c'est à chacun de...

Step 5. The teacher's point

Teacher script. Start from the video: ask what happens to the book (selected, printed, labelled, mailed). Write the passive forms. Then ask why Dolly did it, and collect purpose sentences.

Point	Form	Example
Purpose	to + verb; in order to + verb (formal); so that + subject + can / could	She gave money to help research. She created the library so that children could love books.
Present passive	be + past participle (+ by + agent)	A book is sent every month. The titles are chosen by a committee.
will	prediction about the future	Her songs will live on. Children will still receive books.

Quick check. Make it passive: *The library sends a book every month.* → **A book is sent every month (by the library).**

Step 6. Exercises

Exercise 1. Match the action and the goal.
1. She created the Imagination Library · 2. She gave a million dollars to Vanderbilt · 3. She built Dollywood near her home · 4. She paid $500 to graduates
a. to support COVID-19 research · b. so that children could love reading · c. to create jobs in her region · d. so that students would finish school

Exercise 2. The journey of a book (present passive). Each book (choose) ... by a committee. Then it (print) ... and (label) ... . Finally it (mail) ... to the child, at no cost to the family.

Exercise 3. Transform into the passive.
1. Volunteers register the children. 2. The postal service delivers the books. 3. Local partners fund the programme.

Exercise 4. Purpose: reformulate with *so that*.
1. She opened the park to create jobs. (so that people / can) 2. She sent books to help children read. (so that children / could)

Exercise 5. A tribute (80 to 100 words): who she was, two things she did (past simple), why (to / so that), what will remain (will). Respectful tone.
Model answer: Dolly Parton was a singer, a songwriter and a generous woman. She grew up poor in Tennessee. She created the Imagination Library so that children could have books at home, and she gave money to help research during the COVID-19 pandemic. Her songs, like *Jolene* and *9 to 5*, will live on, and millions of children will remember the books with her name. Her life shows that you can come from nothing and give a lot.

Help box. Frame: *Dolly Parton was... She created... so that... She gave... to... Her songs will...*
Going further. Present perfect for a review: *She has inspired millions of people. The library has sent more than 330 million books.*

Step 7. Speaking task: "The radio tribute"

1. **Individual preparation (3 min).** Prepare a 45-second radio tribute: one fact, one goal, one thing that will remain.
2. **Groups of four (4 min).** Each student performs; the others note one purpose sentence they hear.
3. **Class debate (2 min).** *Is generosity a private choice or a public duty for the very rich?* Three volunteers answer with one argument each.

Possible answer: It is up to each person to decide, but I think the very rich have a moral duty to give back. Dolly did not have to create the library, yet she did it so that children could read. That is why her name will live on.

Step 8. Written record

> ***Lesson 8. Dolly's legacy***
> *Dolly Parton died on 25 August 2026, aged 80. She created the Dollywood Foundation (1988) to fight school dropout and the Imagination Library (1995) so that young children could receive a book every month. More than 330 million books have been sent. In 2020, she gave a million dollars for COVID-19 research.*
> ***Grammar.*** *Purpose: to / in order to / so that + could. Present passive: is sent, are chosen. will: her music will live on.*
> ***My answer:*** *I think generosity is... because...*

Step 9. Homework

1. Prepare the final task: choose your group and your role (see Lesson 9).
2. Revise all flashcards from Lessons 1 to 8 (3-box method).
3. Help box: record your 45-second tribute and listen to it once.

Passing the torch. "I will always love her and want to make her proud." (Miley Cyrus, 26 August 2026). How can we carry on someone's legacy?

Lesson 9. Final task and summative assessment

Question of the sequence: Is a legacy what a person leaves behind, or what other people decide to make of it?

Stop point (minute 34). All groups have performed (or the remaining groups are scheduled at the start of the next hour).

Emergency exit (8 minutes). If the class is large, Parts C and D are done at home as a timed task (30 minutes), and the lesson is used only for the performances.

Step 1. Recap

1. Give one goal of the Imagination Library. 2. Make it passive: *They send a book every month.* 3. Name the three backstage professionals.

Final task: Backstage at the tribute concert

Student sheet

Your group (four students) prepares a tribute concert for Dolly Parton. You must:

1. **Present Dolly (2 minutes, two students):** her childhood, her look, *9 to 5*, Dollywood, her generosity. Past simple, used to, one comparative.
2. **Play one backstage scene (2-3 minutes, two students):** dresser, hairdresser or make-up artist, with the role cards of Lesson 3.
3. **True or Tale? (1 minute, whole group):** tell the audience about the inheritance rumour and explain why it is not verified.
4. **Conclusion (30 seconds, one student):** answer the question of the sequence.

Requirements: at least three past forms, one reported sentence, two modals of deduction, five words of the Dolly look, one purpose sentence, one source named for every fact ("according to...").

Checklist before you perform
- [ ] Every member speaks at least 1 minute 30.
- [ ] We don't read: we use cards with key words only.
- [ ] We have named at least three sources.
- [ ] We use at least ten words from our flashcards.

Part A · Speaking: present Dolly (5 points)

Criterion	1	2	3
Content: correct facts about her life	few facts	most facts correct	rich and correct facts, with sources
Fluency and pronunciation	hard to follow	understandable	clear and natural
Language: vocabulary reused and syntax (past simple, used to, comparatives)	many errors	some errors	mostly correct, varied

Score: total of the three lines (3 to 9) converted: 3-4 = 1, 5 = 2, 6 = 3, 7-8 = 4, 9 = 5.

Part B · Interaction: backstage role-play (5 points)

Criterion	Not yet (0)	Nearly (1)	Reached (2)	Beyond (3)
Interaction	I read my card only	short answers	I answer and ask questions	I react, suggest and negotiate
Polite requests, offers, suggestions	none	Can I / I want	Could you / Would you like me to / What about	It might look better if / I'd rather / Would it be possible
Professional vocabulary	fewer than 3 words	3 to 5	6 to 9	10 or more, used precisely
Pronunciation and fluency	hard to understand	understandable with pauses	clear, few pauses	clear and natural
Language: syntax	many errors	errors in questions	modals and questions correct	varied and correct

Score: total out of 15, divided by 3.

Part C · Reading: fact-check article (5 points)

> ***Fact-check: did Miley inherit Dolly's millions?***
> *After Dolly Parton's death in August 2026, a video spread online. In it, Miley Cyrus seems to say that her godmother left her entire fortune to her. Fact-checkers at Lead Stories analysed the clip with a detection tool: it is very likely AI-generated. The voice is monotone and the lips do not match the words. According to court documents, Dolly's property is managed by a private trust created in 1997, so the names of the people who inherit are not public. In 2020, Dolly said she had organised everything so that nobody would have to deal with a "mess". Miley's only public message after the death was a tribute about love, grief and music. Experts say: before you share, check who posted it and whether reliable media report it.*
> *(Text written for this assessment from the sources of Lesson 7.)*

1. True or false? Fact-checkers think the video is real. Justify.
2. Why are the names of the people who inherit not public?
3. What did Dolly say in 2020?
4. What was Miley's only public message about?
5. Give the two pieces of advice from the experts.

Part D · Writing (5 points)

Choose one subject (100 words):
1. Write a tribute to Dolly Parton for your school website.
2. Describe one of Dolly's stage looks and give your opinion.
3. Answer the question of the sequence: *Is a legacy what a person leaves behind, or what other people make of it?*

Criterion	0	1	2
Content: relevant, organised, facts correct	off topic	partly relevant	relevant and organised
Language: syntax (tenses, passive, purpose, modals)	many errors	some errors	mostly correct, varied
Language: vocabulary of the sequence	fewer than 5 words	5 words or more	

Model for subject 2. For the show, Dolly wore a sparkly pink rhinestone suit with high white boots. Her big platinum wig had soft curls and a lot of volume. Her make-up was bright: lilac eyeshadow, false lashes and scarlet lipstick. I think her look was glamorous and a bit over the top, but it was her own style. As she joked, it cost a lot of money to look that cheap! Although she looked artificial, she never forgot the coat of rags of her childhood.

Model for subject 3. I think a legacy is both. On the one hand, Dolly left real things: songs, a park that employs thousands of people, and a library that has sent more than 330 million books. These things exist whatever people say. On the other hand, other people decide what to make of them: Warhol turned her into an icon, Miley sings her songs, and some people even invented a fake inheritance. That is why we must check our sources: a legacy should be remembered, not invented.

Teacher's summary grid (/20)

Part	Points	Of which Language
A. Speaking: present Dolly	/5	1 line of 3
B. Interaction	/5	1 line of 5
C. Reading	/5	
D. Writing	/5	3 points of 5
Total	**/20**	

Student self-correction grid (summative)

Part	My mark	What I missed (words of the teacher's grid)	Flashcards I must revise	My improved version (written or recorded)
A. Present Dolly	/5			
B. Role-play	/5			
C. Reading	/5			
D. Writing	/5			

Instruction. Rewrite Part D following the teacher's grid line by line; record again your presentation (Part A) in 2 minutes. Underline the words and structures you have added.

Homework (after the sequence)

1. Self-correction of the summative assessment (grid above + improved version).
2. Write three sentences: *What can I say now that I could not say before this sequence?*
3. Optional, at home: watch the film *9 to 5* (1980) in English with English subtitles, and write five sentences comparing the film and the song.

Passing the torch. From the cabin in the Smoky Mountains to the Warhol portrait, from *9 to 5* to the Imagination Library, Dolly passed on songs, values and courage. Miley carries part of the torch; you can carry another part.

Appendix A. CFA pathway: hair and beauty

For: apprentices preparing the CAP Métiers de la coiffure, the BP Coiffure, the CAP Esthétique, cosmétique, parfumerie, the BP Esthétique, cosmétique, parfumerie, and students of the bacs pro Métiers de la coiffure and Esthétique cosmétique parfumerie.
How to use it: after Lessons 1, 2 and 3. One lesson of 55 minutes (planned over 52). Lessons 7 and 8 complete the portrait.
Debatable question: Is a "Dolly look" a costume or a real service you can sell?

Stop point (minute 44). Every apprentice has played the professional.
Emergency exit (8 minutes). Each apprentice asks the client five questions (consultation only), then writes the price and time line of the service description.

Step 1. Recap

1. Three words for hair and three for make-up from Lesson 2. 2. Make it polite: *I want more volume.* 3. What colour was Dolly's eyeshadow in the Warhol portrait?

Step 2. Expanding your vocabulary

Hair

Word	Meaning	Example
a wig / a hairpiece	false hair for the whole head / for part of it	Dolly wore a wig on stage.
extensions	hair added to make it longer or thicker	Extensions add volume.
styling	giving a shape to the hair	Wig styling takes time.
a blow-dry	drying and styling with a hairdryer and a brush	I'll start with a blow-dry.
volume	the impression of a lot of hair	We need more volume on top.
curls / rollers / a curling iron	round locks / tools to make curls	Hot rollers give big curls.
bleaching	making hair lighter with a product	Platinum blonde needs bleaching.
highlights	lighter strands of hair	Golden highlights look warm.
roots	the part of the hair near the scalp	Your roots are darker.
a toner	a product that corrects the shade	A toner removes yellow tones.
hairspray	a spray that keeps the style in place	Use hairspray for the stage.

Beauty

Word	Meaning	Example
foundation	cream that evens the skin colour	Choose a foundation for your skin type.
concealer	product that hides dark circles or spots	A little concealer under the eyes.
contouring	shaping the face with darker and lighter shades	Contouring makes the cheekbones stand out.
highlighter	a shiny product for the top of the cheeks	Highlighter catches the stage lights.
eyeshadow / eyeliner	colour on the eyelids / a line along the lashes	Lilac eyeshadow, black eyeliner.
false lashes / lash glue	artificial eyelashes / the glue for them	False lashes need a patch test.
nail extensions	artificial long nails	Dolly wore long acrylic nails.
stage make-up	strong make-up for lights and cameras	Stage make-up must be bright.
a patch test	testing a product on a small area of skin first	We do a patch test 48 hours before.
skin type	dry, oily, combination or sensitive skin	What is your skin type?

Words to sell a service: It's ideal for... · It includes... · It will last... · I'd recommend... · Please note that...

Exercise 1. Hair or beauty? Sort: rollers, concealer, toner, false lashes, highlights, contouring, hairspray, foundation.

Exercise 2. Fill in the gaps: patch test · skin type · roots · toner
Before the lashes, we need a (1) **__. What is your (2) _*? Your (3) are darker, so we'll use a (4)*** ___ after bleaching.

Flashcards (model). a patch test · test cutané · *We do a patch test 48 hours before.* / **It will take about + time** (red) · *It will take about an hour.*

Step 3. The teacher's point

Teacher script. Play the professional with one apprentice as the client. Ask five questions. The group notes the questions, then classifies them yes/no or wh-.

Point	Example
Yes/no questions	Do you have any allergies? Is it for a special occasion? Have you ever worn a wig?
Wh- questions	What look would you like? How long do you have? When is the concert?
Offers and advice	Would you like me to add volume? I'd recommend a patch test. It might look better if we use a lighter shade.
will: time and result	It will take about an hour. Your curls will last all night.

Quick check. Make a question: *you / allergies / have* → **Do you have any allergies?**

Step 4. Exercises

Exercise 3. The steps of a Dolly look. Put in order: a. add false lashes · b. apply foundation · c. put on the wig and add hairspray · d. welcome the client and do the consultation · e. apply eyeshadow and lipstick

Exercise 4. Questions for the client. Write the questions: 1 occasion? 2 allergies? 3 skin type? 4 wig or own hair? 5 time available?

Exercise 5. Transform with will. 1 The service / take / ninety minutes. 2 The curls / last / all night.

Step 5. Role-play with a client

Situation. A client comes to your salon. She is going to a Dolly Parton tribute concert on Saturday night and wants "a Dolly look": big hair and stage make-up.

Role card A · The client
1. Explain the occasion and what you want.
2. Answer the questions (hair, skin, allergies).
3. Ask about the price and the time.
4. Accept or refuse a suggestion politely.

Role card B · The professional
1. Welcome the client and ask about the occasion.
2. Ask about allergies and skin or hair type; suggest a patch test.
3. Suggest a service: wig or styling, stage make-up, lashes.
4. Give the price and the time, and book the appointment.

Help: Hello, can I help you? · Do you have allergies? · It's ... euros. · I want... · How much is it?
Core: Would you like me to...? · What about false lashes? · It will take about... · I'd rather...
Going further: I'd recommend a patch test before... · With your skin type, I'd suggest... · Would it be possible to...?

Professional words: appointment, consultation, patch test, allergy, skin type, hair type, price list, booking, aftercare.

Model dialogue (read it after your own performance)
Professional: Good morning! How can I help you?
Client: I'm going to a Dolly Parton tribute concert. I'd like a Dolly look!
Professional: Great idea. Would you like me to style your hair or would you rather wear a wig?
Client: A wig, please. Something big and platinum.
Professional: Perfect. For the make-up, do you have any allergies? I'd recommend a patch test for the lash glue.
Client: No allergies. How much is it and how long will it take?
Professional: The wig styling and stage make-up package is 75 euros and it takes about an hour and a half. Shall I book you for Saturday at four?
Client: Yes, please. I love the idea!

Apprentices can also play Scene 2 (hairdresser) or Scene 3 (make-up artist) of Lesson 3.

Step 6. Written task: a service description (60 to 80 words)

Name of the service, what it includes, who it is for, the time, the price, one precaution.
Help frame: *The ... package includes ... It is perfect for ... It takes ... It costs ... Please note: ...*
Model answer: The Dolly Look: stage hair and make-up package. Ready for a tribute night? Our team styles a platinum wig with big soft curls and lots of volume, then creates a bright stage make-up: contouring, lilac eyeshadow, false lashes and red lips. Perfect for concerts, parties and photo shoots. Time: about 90 minutes. Price: 75 euros. Please note: a patch test is required 48 hours before for the lash glue.

Assessment grid (CFA)

Criterion	Not yet	Nearly	Reached	Beyond
Interaction with the client	I read my card	short answers	I answer and ask questions	I advise, negotiate, book
Questions and offers	none	Can I / I want	Do you have...? / Would you like me to...?	I'd recommend / With your skin type, I'd suggest
Professional vocabulary	fewer than 3 words	3 to 5	6 to 9	10 or more, precisely
Health and safety (patch test, allergies)	not mentioned	mentioned	explained	explained with the time (48 h)
Language: vocabulary reused and syntax	many errors	errors in questions	questions and will correct	varied and correct

Self-correction grid (CFA). Same lines; columns: *What I did / What I missed / My improved version*. Rewrite your service description following the grid.

Homework

1. Learn ten words from each vocabulary table (flashcards).
2. Write a second service description (for example "Rhinestone nails" or "Big hair blow-dry").
3. Record yourself welcoming a client (one minute).

Passing the torch. Dolly said her style was "a country girl's idea of glam". Behind it, there were professionals: wig makers, hairdressers, make-up artists. Which part of her look would you like to recreate in your salon?

Appendix B. Couture pathway: the dresser's card

For: students of the CAP Métiers de la mode, vêtement flou, the bac pro Métiers de la couture et de la confection, and any bac pro class working on the world of shows.
How to use it: after Lessons 2 (the Dolly look, Coat of Many Colors) and 3 (backstage). One lesson of 55 minutes (planned over 52).
Debatable question: Is a stage costume a piece of art or a technical tool?

Stop point (minute 40). Every student has played the dresser.
Emergency exit (8 minutes). Each student describes one costume in three passive sentences, aloud.

Step 1. Recap

1. What did Dolly's mother use to make the coat? 2. Three words for bling. 3. Make it polite: *Make it shorter.*

Step 2. Expanding your vocabulary

Word	Meaning	Example
a fitting	trying on a garment to adjust it	The fitting is at six.
a hem / a seam	the folded bottom edge / the line where two pieces are sewn	Let's shorten the hem.
to take in / to let out	to make tighter / to make wider	Can you take it in at the waist?
a zip / Velcro / snaps	fastenings	A zip is faster for a quick change.
rhinestones / sequins / beads	shiny decorations sewn or glued on	The suit is covered in rhinestones.
fringe	hanging threads or strips as decoration	a white fringe jacket
patchwork	fabric made of small pieces sewn together	The coat of many colours was patchwork.
a quick change	a very fast change of costume during a show	She has a quick change after song three.
a rack / a steamer	a rail for clothes / a machine that removes creases	Put the costumes on the rack.
lining	fabric inside a garment	The lining is in satin.

Exercise 1. Match. 1 hem · 2 lining · 3 to take in · 4 steamer / a fabric inside · b remove creases · c bottom edge · d make tighter

Exercise 2. Fill in the gaps: zip · fitting · rack · rhinestones
At the (1) **__, Dolly tries the pink suit. It is covered in (2) _.** ***For the quick change, we use a (3) . After the show, the costumes go back on the (4) ___.***

Flashcards (model). to take in · reprendre (resserrer) · *Can you take it in at the waist?* / **is made of + material** (red) · *The jacket is made of satin.*

Step 3. The teacher's point: the present passive

Point	Example
be + past participle	The jacket is made of satin. The rhinestones are sewn by hand. The dress is lined with silk.
by + agent (if useful)	The costume was designed by a stage designer.
Adjective order	a long sparkly pink satin gown

Quick check. Make it passive: *We sew the sequins by hand.* → **The sequins are sewn by hand.**

Step 4. Exercises

Exercise 3. Transform into the passive. 1 We close the jacket with a hidden zip. 2 We decorate the sleeves with fringe. 3 They line the trousers with silk.

Exercise 4. Adjective order. 1 a (satin / pink / beautiful) jacket 2 (long / white / silk) fringe

Step 5. The dresser scene

Use Scene 1 of Lesson 3 (role cards, starters, professional words and model dialogue). Add one constraint: the dresser must explain one alteration in the passive (*The hem will be shortened by two centimetres.*).

Step 6. Productions

Technical sheet (60 words). Garment, fabric, colour, decoration, fastening for the quick change. Three passive forms.
Model answer: Stage suit, pink. The jacket is made of satin and it is decorated with rhinestones on the shoulders. The trousers are lined. The jacket is closed with a hidden zip, so it can be removed in less than a minute during the quick change. White fringe is sewn on the sleeves.

Patchwork presentation (oral, 1 minute). Inspired by the coat of many colours, design a patchwork piece. Present it: colours, fabrics, meaning, and what you want to pass on.

Assessment grid (couture)

Criterion	Not yet	Nearly	Reached	Beyond
Interaction (dresser scene)	I read my card	short answers	I answer and ask	I suggest and negotiate
Technical description	no structure	list of words	garment, fabric, decoration, fastening	precise and justified
Professional vocabulary	fewer than 3	3 to 5	6 to 9	10 or more
Language: vocabulary reused and syntax (passive, adjective order)	many errors	some errors	mostly correct	varied and correct

Self-correction grid (couture). Same lines; columns: *What I did / What I missed / My improved version*. Rewrite your technical sheet following the grid.

Homework

1. Learn the vocabulary (flashcards).
2. Describe in 60 words your favourite stage costume (any artist), with a link to an official source.
3. Record your patchwork presentation.

Expanding your vocabulary: the flashcard method

Students make their own flashcards in every lesson. They can use index cards (A7) or a flashcard app on their phone.

How to make a card

1. Front: the word or the structure, in English.
2. Back, line 1: the meaning (English definition or French translation).
3. Back, line 2: an example in context, taken from the lesson.
4. Back, line 3: a sound tip (stressed syllable underlined, or a word that rhymes).
5. Colour code: navy = theme vocabulary; gold = words to argue and analyse; red = grammar structures.

Blank template

FRONT	BACK
Word or structure: __	Meaning: __
Colour: navy / gold / red	Example from the lesson: __
Lesson n° __	Sound tip: __

How to revise

- In class: two minutes at the start of every lesson ("flashcard duel": student A shows the front, student B gives the back, then they swap).
- At home: the 3-box system. Box 1 = cards I don't know (every day); box 2 = cards I almost know (every two days); box 3 = cards I know (once a week). A card moves up a box when you get it right, and goes back to box 1 when you get it wrong.
- Before each assessment: one full revision of all cards of the lessons concerned.